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Daily brief · 2026-07-31

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Last 7 daily reports

3 deep-dives you should really read

Hush Security says the AI security problem has shifted from protecting models to governing identities as autonomous agents spread

VentureBeat – AI · Topic: **AI/Cloud/Quantum**

- **What it is:** Israeli cybersecurity startup Hush Security announced a \$30 million Series A, stating that enterprise AI security has fundamentally shifted from protecting models to governing autonomous agent identities.
- **Who:** Hush Security, backed by investors like Battery Ventures, YL Ventures, and strategic investor Akamai, focuses on non-human identity security for software and now autonomous AI agents.
- **What it does:** Hush extends its platform into an "Identity Gateway" for AI agents, discovering them, assigning identities, brokering task-specific permissions, and maintaining centralized audit logs.
- **Why it matters:** The rapid spread of autonomous AI agents acting independently across multiple enterprise systems creates significant security gaps with existing identity governance models, amplifying risk.
- **Strategic view:** TMT executives must urgently implement robust, dedicated identity governance for autonomous AI agents to safely scale AI adoption while mitigating escalating security and compliance risks.

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Mastercard spent decades training its fraud system to see bots as thieves. Now bots are the ones doing the buying.

VentureBeat – AI · Topic: **AI/Cloud/Quantum**

- **What it is:** Mastercard is fundamentally evolving its payment fraud systems to enable and secure legitimate transactions conducted by AI agents, shifting from blocking bots to fostering trusted agentic commerce.
- **Who:** Mastercard, a global payments technology company, is collaborating with tech giants like Microsoft, OpenAI, and Google, while impacting consumers, businesses, and various AI-powered transactional agents.
- **What it does:** Mastercard is developing a 'scaled trust infrastructure' with five layers—identity, verifiable intent, controls, execution via Agent Pay, and intelligence—to secure AI-driven, delegated commerce.
- **Why it matters:** This transformation is crucial for enabling autonomous B2B procurement and consumer purchases, ensuring trust, accountability, and the continued scaling of AI-powered services across the economy.
- **Strategic view:** For TMT executives, this signifies a critical shift toward 'know your agent' and verifiable intent as foundational requirements for future autonomous commerce, making trust infrastructure a competitive imperative.

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The lineage behind 69% of open models was never verified. Cisco just fingerprinted almost 900 for free

VentureBeat – AI · Topic: **AI/Cloud/Quantum**

- **What it is:** Cisco's new AI Supply Chain Provenance Explorer is a free public database that verifies the true lineage and security status of nearly 900 open AI models using advanced fingerprinting.
- **Who:** Cisco developed the AI Supply Chain Provenance Explorer to address critical security and trust gaps in open AI models widely used by enterprises and hosted on platforms like Hugging Face.
- **What it does:** It accurately fingerprints the derivation of open AI models, replacing unreliable self-reported tags with verified data on lineage, license, and scan coverage to enhance AI supply chain transparency.
- **Why it matters:** This matters because unverified AI model lineage poses substantial security risks and compliance challenges, a critical gap traditional supply chain tools fail to adequately address.
- **Strategic view:** This tool establishes a vital foundation for secure AI adoption and governance, reducing enterprise risk from unverified models and setting a new standard for AI supply chain transparency.

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CEO POV · AI & Space Economy

No CEO statements collected for today.

Patent watch · Compute / Video / Data / Cloud

No relevant patent publications detected for today (EPO / USPTO).

Curated watchlist · 3-5 links per topic

TV / Streaming

No notable articles for this topic today.

Telco / 5G

No notable articles for this topic today.

Media / Platforms

No notable articles for this topic today.

AI / Cloud / Quantum

- [Thinking Machines debuts Inkle Small open source AI model nearing performance of predecessor at about 1/4 size](#) (VentureBeat – AI) ☐ Add to Weekly
- [AI price wars: OpenAI cuts GPT-5.6 Luna prices by 80% as model competition shifts toward cost](#) (VentureBeat – AI) ☐ Add to Weekly
- [Not just OpenAI: Now Anthropic says its internal models got online and cyberattacked 3 other organizations](#) (VentureBeat – AI) ☐ Add to Weekly
- [Everyone Is Freaking Out About OpenAI and Anthropic’s Race for Dominance](#) (Wired – Business) ☐ Add to Weekly
- [The Download: tricking LLMs, and reviving geothermal plants](#) (MIT Technology Review – Tech) ☐ Add to Weekly

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